
AP English Literature and Composition

Practice Exam

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ENGLISH LITERATURE AND COMPOSITION

SECTION I

Time—1 hour

Directions: This section consists of selections from literary works and questions on their content, form, and style. After reading each passage or poem, choose the best answer to each question and then fill in the corresponding circle on the answer sheet.

Note: Pay particular attention to the requirements of questions that contain the words NOT, LEAST, or EXCEPT.

Questions 1-10. Read the following poem carefully before you choose your answers.

Prologue to a Supposed Play

Line My worthy hearers, have you come tonight
To feast on comedy that's brisk and light,
And gladly spend an idle hour or two
In viewing pictures that are just like you?
5 If this is what you want, just let me say
You couldn't turn your heads a better way;
And for each cent you gave to enter here
You should take back a modicum of cheer,
And weigh yourselves so well that you will be
10 Arrayed against your insufficiency.

But this is preaching? Well, the comic stage
Has preached through ridicule to every age.
Man scorns his shallow deed and sordid pelf*
When he's employed in laughing at himself.
15 So let us preach in every way that can
Lift man up to the dignity of man.
Now, don't be too exact, but let good sense
Decide the point of honest eminence;
And bear in mind that what is trite and true,
20 If well managed, is worthy through and through.

But to the play. It comes in five long acts,
In which the weapons used are naked facts.
There is no effort made to polish darts
That find a lodgement in deceitful hearts,
25 Nor to put on the rouge an honest mask,
For that would be, indeed, a fruitless task.
The characters are plain, as you will see,
And richly freighted with humanity;
And, by the way, their actions prove in making
30 A man of noble parts; the undertaking
Is such that nature seldom deigns to run
The same material on from sire to son.

The actors are a queer and jolly set,
Whose fun increases as you fume and fret;
35 So, should they hurl at you eccentric airs,
Just dodge as though they struck you unawares,
Or jesting strive to make a pointed hit,
Just hold your peace and let it pass for wit.
Now, my good hearers, hint what I shall say next.
40 You want to hear no more? Bring on the play next?
Well, here it is, and if you don't grow wiser,
Censure yourselves as well as the advisor.

(1898)

* pelf: wealth

1. The speaker indicates that the play will include
 - (A) discussions of subjects unfamiliar to the audience
 - (B) mockery of characters similar to the audience
 - (C) ridicule of outdated literary fashions
 - (D) condemnation of society's unsophisticated tastes
 - (E) celebration of the audience's desire to be reassured
2. The speaker anticipates the objection that "preaching" (line 11) is
 - (A) an inadequate examination of the human condition
 - (B) a scandalous feature in a drama
 - (C) an inappropriate element in a comedy
 - (D) an unexpected and annoying interruption
 - (E) a deplorable practice in any social context

3. In both lines 11 and 21, the speaker begins sentences with “But” primarily to
 - (A) indicate a personal comment
 - (B) concede an exception
 - (C) signal a shift in the discourse
 - (D) present and then dismiss an objection
 - (E) reflect the confusion inherent in the poem’s argument
4. The speaker suggests that the “naked facts” (line 22) will
 - (A) shock naïve audiences with a cynical picture of human nature
 - (B) enable those attending the play to indulge in wishful fantasies
 - (C) challenge playgoers to tolerate the playwright’s bias against hypocrites
 - (D) encourage members of the audience to address their own weaknesses
 - (E) require the audience to rely on their knowledge of history
5. In context, the phrase “richly freighted” (line 28) implies that
 - (A) characters’ flaws help make them human
 - (B) riches always carry imperfections with them
 - (C) real humanity is rarely found in characters
 - (D) being human involves unavoidable responsibilities
 - (E) all people carry the burden of personal anxieties
6. The figurative language in the final stanza (lines 33-42) draws most heavily on which activity?
 - (A) Philosophical debate
 - (B) Musical performance
 - (C) Religious ritual
 - (D) Public celebration
 - (E) Armed confrontation
7. The speaker expects the audience to have felt all of the following by the end of the performance EXCEPT
 - (A) high spirits
 - (B) amusement
 - (C) relief
 - (D) indignation
 - (E) impatience
8. Overall, the speaker characterizes the audience as
 - (A) overly hostile to the play’s villainous characters
 - (B) admirably patient with the complexities of the plot
 - (C) ultimately agreeable to reforms of social institutions
 - (D) potentially receptive to humorous satire
 - (E) fundamentally decent despite its tendency to preach
9. Which of the following best describes the effect of the poem’s rhyming couplets?
 - (A) They directly illustrate the banality of the poem’s topic.
 - (B) They playfully make the poem’s unpleasant points more palatable.
 - (C) They create a light tone to emphasize the frivolous themes of the play.
 - (D) They explicitly mock the audience’s expectations.
 - (E) They mirror the rapid shifts in the speaker’s thoughts.
10. The poem is best described as
 - (A) an elaborate analysis of the social history of comedy
 - (B) an extended reflection on the nature of comedy
 - (C) a passionate monologue about the nobility of human nature
 - (D) a comical complaint about the shortcomings of playwrights
 - (E) an idiosyncratic description of a canonical play

Questions 11-22. Read the following passage carefully before you choose your answers.

Mr. Rushworth was from the first struck with the beauty of Miss Bertram, and being inclined to marry, soon fancied himself in love. He was a heavy young man, with not more than common sense; but as there was nothing disagreeable in his figure or address, the young lady was well pleased with her conquest. Being now in her twenty-first year, Maria Bertram was beginning to think matrimony a duty; and as a marriage with Mr. Rushworth would give her the enjoyment of a larger income than her father's, as well as ensure her the house in town, which was now a prime object, it became, by the same rule of moral obligation, her evident duty to marry Mr. Rushworth if she could. Mrs. Norris was most zealous in promoting the match, by every suggestion and contrivance, likely to enhance its desirableness to either party; and, among other means, by seeking an intimacy with the gentleman's mother, who at present lived with him, and to whom she even forced Lady Bertram to go through ten miles of indifferent road, to pay a morning visit. It was not long before a good understanding took place between this lady and herself. Mrs. Rushworth acknowledged herself very desirous that her son should marry, and declared that of all the young ladies she had ever seen, Miss Bertram seemed, by her amiable qualities and accomplishments, the best adapted to make him happy. Mrs. Norris accepted the compliment, and admired the nice discernment of character which could so well distinguish merit. Maria was indeed the pride and delight of them all—perfectly faultless—an angel; and of course, so surrounded by admirers, must be difficult in her choice; but yet as far as Mrs. Norris could allow herself to decide on so short an acquaintance, Mr. Rushworth appeared precisely the young man to deserve and attach her.

After dancing with each other at a proper number of balls, the young people justified these opinions, and an engagement, with a due reference to the absent Sir Thomas, was entered into, much to the satisfaction of their respective families, and of the general lookers-on of the neighbourhood, who had, for many weeks past, felt the expediency of Mr. Rushworth's marrying Miss Bertram.

It was some months before Sir Thomas's consent could be received; but in the mean while, as no one felt a doubt of his most cordial pleasure in the connection, the intercourse of the two families was

carried on without restraint, and no other attempt made at secrecy, than Mrs. Norris's talking of it every where as a matter not to be talked of at present.

Edmund was the only one of the family who could see a fault in the business; but no representation of his aunt's could induce him to find Mr. Rushworth a desirable companion. He could allow his sister to be the best judge of her own happiness, but he was not pleased that her happiness should centre in a large income; nor could he refrain from often saying to himself, in Mr. Rushworth's company, "If this man had not twelve thousand a year, he would be a very stupid fellow."

(1814)

11. In the first sentence of the passage, the narrator implies which of the following about Mr. Rushworth?
 - (A) If he had not thought that Miss Bertram was beautiful, he might nonetheless have been inclined to marry her.
 - (B) If he had already been married when he met Miss Bertram, he would not have thought that she was beautiful.
 - (C) If he had not been disposed to get married, he might not have thought himself in love with Miss Bertram.
 - (D) If he had known much about Miss Bertram other than her physical beauty, he would not have thought he was in love with her.
 - (E) If he had truly loved Miss Bertram, he would have wanted to marry her even if she were not beautiful.
12. Which statement best describes the narrative technique employed in lines 3-6 ("He was . . . conquest") ?
 - (A) The narrator generates humor by means of hyperbole.
 - (B) The narrator uses negation to convey mere adequacy.
 - (C) The narrator cites a particular instance as the basis for a generalization.
 - (D) The narrator uses an oxymoron to highlight a contradiction.
 - (E) The narrator underscores a point with a redundant reiteration.

13. In line 10, “enjoyment” is best understood to mean
- (A) extravagance
 - (B) appraisal
 - (C) diversion
 - (D) interest
 - (E) use
14. The attraction that Miss Bertram feels for Mr. Rushworth is best characterized as
- (A) material
 - (B) physical
 - (C) idealistic
 - (D) intellectual
 - (E) moral
15. The “understanding” (line 22) between Mrs. Norris and Mrs. Rushworth is marked by
- (A) wary distrust
 - (B) veiled hostility
 - (C) mutual flattery
 - (D) genuine fondness
 - (E) subtle rivalry
16. The narrator’s attitude toward the characters presented in the first paragraph (lines 1-36) is best described as
- (A) jovial enthusiasm
 - (B) reluctant admiration
 - (C) scientific curiosity
 - (D) wry amusement
 - (E) scornful disrespect
17. By noting that Mr. Rushworth and Miss Bertram “justified these opinions” (line 38), the narrator implies that they
- (A) rapidly fell in love with each other despite warnings to be cautious
 - (B) dispassionately assessed the advantages of their marriage
 - (C) seemed to have no other serious marital prospects
 - (D) were widely praised as an attractive young couple
 - (E) were viewed by members of their social circle as an appropriate match
18. Lines 49-51 (“and no . . . present”) suggest that Mrs. Norris did which of the following?
- (A) Lent credibility to a rumor by vigorously denying it
 - (B) Implied a fact by conspicuously refusing to discuss it
 - (C) Spread gossip by pretending to be a mere messenger
 - (D) Quelled a scandal by decisively forbidding it to be talked of
 - (E) Bragged about an event by feigning ignorance of its significance
19. In line 53, “representation” is best understood to mean
- (A) likeness
 - (B) symbol
 - (C) argument
 - (D) version
 - (E) delegation
20. It can be inferred from the passage that the narrator regards Edmund’s assessment of Mr. Rushworth (lines 52-61) as
- (A) excessively charitable
 - (B) surprisingly naïve
 - (C) essentially correct
 - (D) unfairly biased
 - (E) overly negative
21. The thoughts described in lines 58-61 (“nor . . . fellow’”) most directly support which view of Mr. Rushworth?
- (A) Money is more important to him than is intelligence.
 - (B) His wealth makes him the undeserving target of criticism.
 - (C) He denies that Miss Bertram is marrying him for his money.
 - (D) Although foolish in other respects, he is financially astute.
 - (E) People respect him only because he is wealthy.
22. Mrs. Norris’s role in the passage is that of
- (A) an enthusiastic intermediary
 - (B) an exasperating meddler
 - (C) a thoughtless instigator
 - (D) a self-serving critic
 - (E) a detached observer

Questions 23-32. Read the following poem carefully before you choose your answers.

On Imagination

Thy various works, imperial queen, we see,
How bright their forms! how deck'd with pomp by thee!
Thy wond'rous acts in beauteous order stand,
And all attest how potent is thine hand.

Line

- 5 From *Helicon*'s¹ refulgent heights attend,
Ye sacred choir, and my attempts befriend:
To tell her glories with a faithful tongue,
Ye blooming graces,² triumph in my song.

- 10 Now here, now there, the roving Fancy flies,
Till some lov'd object strikes her wand'ring eyes,
Whose silken fetters all the senses bind,
And soft captivity involves the mind.

- 15 *Imagination!* who can sing thy force?
Or who describe the swiftness of thy course?
Soaring through air to find the bright abode,
Th' empyreal palace of the thund'ring God,
We on thy pinions³ can surpass the wind,
And leave the rolling universe behind:
From star to star the mental optics rove,
20 Measure the skies, and range the realms above.
There in one view we grasp the mighty whole,
Or with new worlds amaze th' unbounded soul.

- 25 Though *Winter* frowns to *Fancy*'s raptur'd eyes
The fields may flourish, and gay scenes arise;
The frozen deeps may break their iron bands,
And bid their waters murmur o'er the sands.
Fair *Flora*⁴ may resume her fragrant reign,
And with her flow'ry riches deck the plain;
*Sylvanus*⁵ may diffuse his honours round,
30 And all the forest may with leaves be crown'd:
Show'rs may descend, and dews their gems disclose,
And nectar sparkle on the blooming rose.

- Such is thy pow'r, nor are thine orders vain,
O thou the leader of the mental train:
35 In full perfection all thy works are wrought,
And thine the sceptre o'er the realms of thought.
Before thy throne the subject-passions bow,
Of subject-passions sov'reign ruler Thou,
At thy command joy rushes on the heart,
40 And through the glowing veins the spirits dart.

- Fancy* might now her silken pinions try
To rise from earth, and sweep th' expanse on high;
From *Tithon*'s bed now might *Aurora* rise,
Her cheeks all glowing with celestial dyes,
45 While a pure stream of light o'erflows the skies.
The monarch of the day I might behold,
And all the mountains tipt with radiant gold,
But I reluctant leave the pleasing views,
Which *Fancy* dresses to delight the *Muse*;
50 *Winter* austere forbids me to aspire,
And northern tempests damp the rising fire;
They chill the tides of *Fancy*'s flowing sea,
Cease then, my song, cease the unequal lay.⁶

(1773)

¹Mount Helicon, the home of the nine Muses

²Greek and Roman goddesses of beauty and charm

³wings

⁴Roman goddess of flowers

⁵Roman god of woodlands, fields, and flocks

⁶song

23. Which statement best characterizes lines 1-4 ("Thy . . . hand") ?
- (A) Classical allusions set the tone for the poem.
 - (B) Strong assertions announce a challenge to other poets.
 - (C) Exclamations reflect the exaggeration implicit in classical myths.
 - (D) Elevated diction evokes the splendor and power of the poem's subject.
 - (E) Heroic couplets accentuate the poem's frivolous subject matter.
24. In context, "attend" (line 5) is best understood to mean
- (A) wait
 - (B) prepare
 - (C) listen
 - (D) take charge
 - (E) be disposed

25. In lines 5-8 (“From . . . song”), the speaker conveys all of the following EXCEPT
- (A) the sanctity and power of music
 - (B) an invocation of the Muses
 - (C) the intention to praise Imagination
 - (D) a rejection of classical icons
 - (E) a desire for poetic success
26. Which of the following statements most precisely characterizes the significance of the imagery in the fifth stanza (lines 23-32) ?
- (A) The reality of winter intensifies the resurgence of hope that attends the arrival of spring.
 - (B) Two personifications—one harsh, one inspirational—confront each other in a mythic struggle for victory.
 - (C) A nonclassical deity, recognized in full magnificence, finally joins the classical deities.
 - (D) Classical divinities of nature illustrate the fallacy that nature sympathizes with human emotion.
 - (E) Envisioned as powerful even over nature, Imagination seems to transform winter into spring.
27. Which of the following literary devices is most obvious in lines 27-28 (“Fair . . . plain”) ?
- (A) Hyperbole
 - (B) Oxymoron
 - (C) Caesura
 - (D) Alliteration
 - (E) Irony
28. The quality most emphasized in lines 29-32 (“*Sylvanus* . . . rose”) is
- (A) opulence
 - (B) dominance
 - (C) intensity
 - (D) movement
 - (E) reverence
29. The imagery in lines 37-40 (“Before . . . dart”) most clearly likens Imagination to
- (A) a miner navigating rich caverns
 - (B) a soldier enduring a long war
 - (C) a monarch sending an army into battle
 - (D) the winner of a hotly contested race
 - (E) the physician of a gravely ill patient
30. The tone of lines 48-53 (“But . . . lay”) is most accurately characterized as
- (A) celebratory
 - (B) determined
 - (C) resigned
 - (D) apprehensive
 - (E) vindictive
31. The poem’s final line (“Cease . . . lay”) provides an ironic antithesis of which previous phrase?
- (A) “From *Helicon*’s refulgent heights” (line 5)
 - (B) “triumph in my song” (line 8)
 - (C) “who can sing thy force?” (line 13)
 - (D) “bid their waters murmur” (line 26)
 - (E) “sweep th’ expanse on high” (line 42)
32. In the poem as a whole, the classical allusions serve most significantly to
- (A) imply that poets’ access to the power of Imagination is diminishing over time
 - (B) signal the speaker’s unconventional treatment of traditional poetic subjects and forms
 - (C) highlight the intense contrast between the grand imaginary realm and the speaker’s everyday reality
 - (D) dramatize a complex set of stories that illustrate humankind’s role in the universe
 - (E) encourage readers to find significant connections between past and present poetic modes

Questions 33-45. Read the following passage carefully before you choose your answers.

The following is an excerpt from an autobiography written in the third person by Henry Adams, a prominent Bostonian.

Line
5 The chief charm of New England was harshness of contrasts and extremes of sensibility—a cold that froze the blood, and a heat that boiled it—so that the pleasure of hating—one’s self if no better victim
10 offered—was not its rarest amusement; but the charm was a true and natural child of the soil, not a cultivated weed of the ancients. The violence of the contrast was real and made the strongest motive of education. The double exterior nature gave life its
15 relative values. Winter and summer, cold and heat, town and country, force and freedom, marked two modes of life and thought, balanced like lobes of the brain. Town was winter confinement, school, rule, discipline; straight, gloomy streets, piled with six feet
20 of snow in the middle; frosts that made the snow sing under wheels or runners; thaws when the streets became dangerous to cross; society of uncles, aunts, and cousins who expected children to behave themselves, and who were not always gratified; above
25 all else, winter represented the desire to escape and go free. Town was restraint, law, unity. Country, only seven miles away, was liberty, diversity, outlawry, the endless delight of mere sense impressions given by nature for nothing, and breathed by boys without knowing it.

Boys are wild animals, rich in the treasures of sense, but the New England boy had a wider range of emotions than boys of more equable climates. He felt his nature crudely, as it was meant. To the boy
30 Henry Adams, summer was drunken. Among senses, smell was the strongest—smell of hot pine-woods and sweet-fern in the scorching summer noon; of new-mown hay; of ploughed earth; of box hedges; of peaches, lilacs, syringas¹; of stables, barns, cow-
35 yards; of salt water and low tide on the marshes; nothing came amiss. Next to smell came taste, and the children knew the taste of everything they saw or touched, from pennyroyal and flagroot² to the shell of a pignut and the letters of a spelling-book—the taste
40 of A-B, AB, suddenly revived on the boy’s tongue sixty years afterwards. Light, line, and color as sensual pleasures, came later and were as crude as the rest. The New England light is glare, and the atmosphere harshens color. The boy was a full man
45 before he ever knew what was meant by atmosphere; his idea of pleasure in light was the blaze of a

New England sun. His idea of color was a peony, with the dew of early morning on its petals. The intense blue of the sea, as he saw it a mile or two away, from
50 the Quincy hills; the cumuli³ in a June afternoon sky; the strong reds and greens and purples of colored prints and children’s picture-books, as the American colors then ran; these were ideals. The opposites or antipathies, were the cold grays of November
55 evenings, and the thick, muddy thaws of Boston winter. With such standards, the Bostonian could not but develop a double nature. Life was a double thing. After a January blizzard, the boy who could look with pleasure into the violent snow-glare of the cold white
60 sunshine, with its intense light and shade, scarcely knew what was meant by tone. He could reach it only by education.

Winter and summer, then, were two hostile lives, and bred two separate natures. Winter was always the
65 effort to live; summer was tropical license.

(1918)

¹Syringas are ornamental shrubs.

²Pennyroyal is a mint plant; flagroot is the root of a particular herb.

³Cumuli are thick clouds.

33. Which of the following best describes the narrator’s main purpose in the passage?
- (A) To reflect nostalgically on his childhood experiences
 - (B) To re-create the childhood environment that shaped his perceptions of the world
 - (C) To detail how the hardships of living in New England contributed to a sense of disillusionment
 - (D) To describe the influence that boyhood friends had on his character
 - (E) To relate a particularly memorable summer in New England
34. In the context of the passage as a whole, the phrase “chief charm” (line 1) is best interpreted to mean
- (A) unsurpassed elegance
 - (B) unexplainable magic
 - (C) defining characteristic
 - (D) unwavering virtue
 - (E) main resource

35. Lines 2-5 (“a cold . . . amusement”) primarily suggest that
- (A) New England residents can easily dismiss hardship in favor of merriment
 - (B) the nature of New England society breeds a perverse enjoyment of misfortune
 - (C) the New England weather produces a coldness of character and a profound self-loathing
 - (D) New England seasonal contrasts produce the capacity to discover a counterintuitive pleasure in adversity
 - (E) the sharpness of New England weather causes residents to repress reality and to delight in fantasy
36. The statement in lines 5-7 (“the charm . . . ancients”) most clearly implies which of the following about New England contrasts?
- (A) They are the undesirable result of outdated customs.
 - (B) They came about naturally, not from established social customs.
 - (C) They often conflict with conventional practices.
 - (D) They tend to make people forget the teachings of their elders.
 - (E) They foster local agricultural methods rather than hinder them.
37. The phrase “To the boy Henry Adams” (lines 29-30) functions primarily as
- (A) a device meant to encourage the reader’s empathy
 - (B) a clarification of the point of view of the preceding lines
 - (C) an indication of a narrative shift from general to specific
 - (D) a means of introducing structural irony in the passage
 - (E) an implication that one boy’s point of view is unique and radical
38. Which of the following best characterizes lines 30-41 (“Among . . . afterwards”) ?
- (A) Language that is understated and spare
 - (B) Associations that are enriched by metaphors and analogies
 - (C) Evocative details that are arranged systematically
 - (D) An argument that is provocative but ultimately specious
 - (E) A description that alternates between subjective impressions and fact
39. In line 42 “crude” is best interpreted to mean
- (A) shallow
 - (B) literal
 - (C) imperfect
 - (D) unrefined
 - (E) obscure
40. In the context of the passage, the words “atmosphere” (line 45) and “tone” (line 61) suggest
- (A) unattainable insights into nature
 - (B) overwhelming states of awareness
 - (C) distorted perceptions of one’s surroundings
 - (D) subtle aspects of one’s environment
 - (E) concrete physical manifestations
41. Which of the following most accurately conveys the meaning of “these were ideals” (line 53) ?
- (A) Henry’s sensory perceptions were vague and inaccurate.
 - (B) Henry’s sensory perceptions were defined by books.
 - (C) The objects Henry observed were mostly the products of his imagination.
 - (D) The objects and colors of summer existed for Henry, not as reality, but as symbols.
 - (E) The intense qualities of Henry’s surroundings represented unqualified standards.
42. In context, “reach” (line 61) is best understood to mean
- (A) strain after
 - (B) arrive at
 - (C) extend
 - (D) influence
 - (E) encompass

The passage is reprinted for your use in answering the remaining questions.

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5 contrasts and extremes of sensibility—a cold that
froze the blood, and a heat that boiled it—so that the
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two modes of life and thought, balanced like lobes of
the brain. Town was winter confinement, school, rule,
discipline; straight, gloomy streets, piled with six feet
15 of snow in the middle; frosts that made the snow sing
under wheels or runners; thaws when the streets
became dangerous to cross; society of uncles, aunts,
and cousins who expected children to behave
themselves, and who were not always gratified; above
20 all else, winter represented the desire to escape and go
free. Town was restraint, law, unity. Country, only
seven miles away, was liberty, diversity, outlawry, the
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Boys are wild animals, rich in the treasures of
sense, but the New England boy had a wider range
of emotions than boys of more equable climates. He
felt his nature crudely, as it was meant. To the boy
30 Henry Adams, summer was drunken. Among senses,
smell was the strongest—smell of hot pine-woods
and sweet-fern in the scorching summer noon; of
new-mown hay; of ploughed earth; of box hedges;
of peaches, lilacs, syringas¹; of stables, barns, cow-
35 yards; of salt water and low tide on the marshes;
nothing came amiss. Next to smell came taste, and the
children knew the taste of everything they saw or
touched, from pennyroyal and flagroot² to the shell of
a pignut and the letters of a spelling-book—the taste
40 of A-B, AB, suddenly revived on the boy’s tongue
sixty years afterwards. Light, line, and color as
sensual pleasures, came later and were as crude as
the rest. The New England light is glare, and the
atmosphere harshens color. The boy was a full man
45 before he ever knew what was meant by atmosphere;
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the dew of early morning on its petals. The intense
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After a January blizzard, the boy who could look with
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Winter and summer, then, were two hostile lives,
and bred two separate natures. Winter was always the
65 effort to live; summer was tropical license.

(1918)

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²Pennyroyal is a mint plant; flagroot is the root of a particular herb.

³Cumuli are thick clouds.

43. In context, “tropical license” (line 65) is best interpreted to mean
- (A) irresponsible wandering
 - (B) undeserved privilege
 - (C) exotic novelty
 - (D) sanctioned indulgence
 - (E) extravagant freedom
44. The author sets up all of the following contrasts in the passage explicitly EXCEPT
- (A) hot versus cold
 - (B) urban versus rural
 - (C) moral versus immoral
 - (D) domesticated versus unrestrained
 - (E) vivid versus drab
45. Which of the following quotations most accurately conveys the central theme of the passage?
- (A) “The double exterior nature gave life its relative values” (lines 9-10)
 - (B) “winter represented the desire to escape” (line 20)
 - (C) “the endless delight of mere sense impressions” (lines 22-23)
 - (D) “Boys are wild animals” (line 26)
 - (E) “the atmosphere harshens color” (lines 43-44)

Questions 46-55. Read the following poem carefully before you choose your answers.

The Dream

Image of her whom I love, more than she,
Whose fair impression in my faithful heart,
Makes me her medal, and makes her love me,
Line As kings do coins, to which their stamps impart
5 The value: go, and take my heart from hence,
Which now is grown too great and good for me:
Honours oppress weak spirits, and our sense
Strong objects dull; the more, the less we see.

When you are gone, and reason gone with you,
10 Then fantasy is queen and soul, and all;
She can present joys meaner¹ than you do;
Convenient, and more proportional.
So, if I dream I have you, I have you,
For, all our joys are but fantastical.
15 And so I 'scape the pain, for pain is true;
And sleep which locks up sense, doth lock out all.

After a such fruition I shall wake,
And, but the waking, nothing shall repent;
And shall to love more thankful sonnets make,
20 Than if more honour, tears, and pains were spent.
But dearest heart, and dearer image stay;
Alas, true joys at best are dream enough;
Though you stay here you pass too fast away:
For even at first life's taper is a snuff.²

25 Filled with her love, may I be rather grown
Mad with much heart, than idiot with none.

(1633)

¹more moderate

²candle end; burned-out piece of wick

46. The image in lines 2-5 ("Whose . . . value") suggests that the beloved's love for the speaker is
- (A) reverent
 - (B) self-serving
 - (C) flattering
 - (D) class-conscious
 - (E) mercenary
47. In the context of the second stanza, "When you are gone" (line 9) implies the
- (A) beloved's death
 - (B) beloved's rejection of the speaker
 - (C) speaker's destruction
 - (D) speaker's falling asleep
 - (E) speaker's feelings of loneliness
48. In the second stanza (lines 9-16), the speaker finds relief in all of the following EXCEPT
- (A) joys
 - (B) sense
 - (C) sleep
 - (D) dream
 - (E) fantasy
49. The repetition of "all" at the end of lines 10 and 16 highlights an opposition between
- (A) fantasy and truth
 - (B) sense and pain
 - (C) fantasy and soul
 - (D) sense and reason
 - (E) joys and dreams
50. Lines 13-14 ("So, if . . . fantastical") convey the idea that
- (A) the dream is frustrating
 - (B) the speaker is anticipating the future
 - (C) dreaming creates new desires
 - (D) dreaming and reality seem equivalent
 - (E) the speaker has awakened
51. The argument of the second stanza (lines 9-16) is that ultimately
- (A) fantasy governs the waking lover's mind
 - (B) joy is strongest when it is least expected
 - (C) love brings the purest form of joy
 - (D) sense precludes the joys supplied by fantasy
 - (E) the joy of love makes one forget the pain

52. As used in line 18, “but” most nearly means
- (A) before
 - (B) upon
 - (C) despite
 - (D) except for
 - (E) in addition to
53. In lines 22-24, the speaker suggests that “true joys” are “dream enough” in that
- (A) as time goes by, memories of childhood inevitably fade
 - (B) because life is fleeting, its joys are necessarily temporary
 - (C) once true joys have been experienced, dreams become irrelevant
 - (D) even lovers who remain together can find that their love gradually diminishes
 - (E) true joys can only be found after the end of one’s earthly life
54. The final couplet creates emphasis in part through the use of
- (A) consonance
 - (B) assonance
 - (C) oxymoron
 - (D) enjambment
 - (E) synesthesia
55. By the end of the poem, the speaker arrives at which of the following resolutions to his dilemma?
- (A) Love is not worth all the suffering it entails.
 - (B) Sense and reason are often aligned with love.
 - (C) Love and truth are preferable to fantasy and dream.
 - (D) The joys of love are too brief and illusory to be valued.
 - (E) One should love a real person at all costs, not one’s own image.

S T O P

END OF SECTION I

**IF YOU FINISH BEFORE TIME IS CALLED, YOU MAY
CHECK YOUR WORK ON THIS SECTION.**

DO NOT GO ON TO SECTION II UNTIL YOU ARE TOLD TO DO SO.

MAKE SURE YOU HAVE DONE THE FOLLOWING.

- **PLACED YOUR AP NUMBER LABEL ON YOUR ANSWER SHEET**
- **WRITTEN AND GRIDDED YOUR AP NUMBER CORRECTLY ON YOUR ANSWER SHEET**
- **TAKEN THE AP EXAM LABEL FROM THE FRONT OF THIS BOOKLET AND PLACED IT ON YOUR ANSWER SHEET**

ENGLISH LITERATURE AND COMPOSITION

SECTION II

Total time—2 hours

Question 1

(Suggested time—40 minutes. This question counts as one-third of the total essay section score.)

The following poem was published in 1896 by Paul Laurence Dunbar. Read the poem carefully. Then, in a well-developed essay, analyze how the speaker explores the nature of his own existence and arrives at conclusions about it. You may wish to consider such elements as figurative language, syntax, and repetition.

The Mystery

I was not; now I am—a few days hence
I shall not be; I fain would look before
And after, but can neither do; some Power
Line Or lack of power says “no” to all I would.
5 I stand upon a wide and sunless plain,
Nor chart nor steel to guide my steps aright.
Whene’er, o’ercoming fear, I dare to move,
I grope without direction and by chance.
Some feign to hear a voice and feel a hand
10 That draws them ever upward thro’ the gloom.
But I—I hear no voice and touch no hand,
Tho’ oft thro’ silence infinite I list,
And strain my hearing to supernal sounds;
Tho’ oft thro’ fateful darkness do I reach,
15 And stretch my hand to find that other hand.
I question of th’ eternal bending skies
That seem to neighbor with the novice earth;
But they roll on, and daily shut their eyes
On me, as I one day shall do on them,
20 And tell me not the secret that I ask.

Question 2

(Suggested time—40 minutes. This question counts as one-third of the total essay section score.)

The following passage, from C. E. Morgan’s novel *All the Living* (2009), describes a young girl’s experience moving away from her extended family in rural Appalachia. Read the passage carefully. Then write a well-developed essay in which you analyze how the author employs literary elements to convey Aloma’s complex responses to her changing environment.

Line She was sent to the mission school the month
before she turned a thankless twelve, not because her
aunt and uncle couldn’t handle her anymore, but
5 because there were nine in the house now—the
adults, their five children, one foster child, and
Aloma. Her aunt and uncle had always been fine to
her, they possessed a kind of hollow-headed decency
that couldn’t be disparaged. When they told her of the
school, they were gentle as doctors, and their voices
10 said, This won’t hurt a bit, and in fact, it had not
really, at least not that Aloma could recall. Only that
first night she found that her eyes stung and to make
them stop she turned facedown into her pillow and let
them tear with her mouth open ragged against the
15 cotton ticking, but in the morning her eyes were better
and she did not cry again, at least not over that.

It was not that her aunt and uncle hadn’t cared for
her—they had never made her feel guilty for their
taking her in when they had no money—but they’d
20 cared in a middling, impersonal way that instinctively
reserved their best for their own. During her first year
at the school, they made their small familial efforts,
they phoned her once a month on Sunday afternoons
and sent little cartooned magazines from their church
25 about crossing a wide river in a phalanx of other
refugees or about Ruth and her numerous losses. Until
she began to play piano, Aloma read these again and
again, carefully, stacked them in neat piles under her
steel-framed bed. She wondered what it meant to
30 uncover a man’s feet, to sleep in his bed, to travel to a
far country, to see enemies drowned. She wondered
what kind of luck was required to be someone other
than the person you were born to be.

The school carried her into a deeper cleavage of the
35 mountains than the one she had known at her uncle’s
trailer, which jagged out like an aluminum finger
from a limestone wall topped by firs, bone out of
bone. There the night carried on and on until ten in
the morning, then the tip of the finger finally burned
40 with its first sun. When she arrived at the school,
Aloma shared a small concrete room with two other
girls and here too the mountain walls staggered and

threatened up over them all. The sun did not appear in
the wound of the holler* until long past eleven where
45 it remained until Spar Mountain, like a curtain of
earth, cut the light before it could naturally sputter
out. It was a chasmed world without the twin
ceremonies of morning and evening.

Aloma lived in this dark place, a dark county in a
50 dark state, and it pressed on her ceaselessly as a girl
until she finally realized in a moment of prescience
that someday adulthood would come with its great
shuddering release and she would be free. Then she
would leave and find a riseless place where nothing
55 impeded the progress of the sun from the moment it
rose in the east until it died out easily, dismissed into
the west. That was what she wanted. That more than
family, that more than friendship, that more than love.
Just the kind of day that couldn’t be recalled into
60 premature darkness by the land.

The only thing she remembered fondly from her
years at her uncle’s trailer was a piano, old with a
tiger-eye top, its weight causing the linoleum floor to
sag. Her aunt played on Sundays after church and the
65 children were made to sit, the restless grappling mass
of them, and sing along. But the churchy songs soon
bored Aloma, hymns were not enough, they contained
the sound in a too-small box of predictable chords.
She wanted to see her aunt’s fingers spider up and
70 down the length of the keyboard, from the woody
lows to the tiny baby sounds of the upper register. She
always wanted more than she was given and secretly
wished her aunt’s hands would slip and press two
neighbor keys at once. It was always dissonance that
75 she liked best.

* holler: hollow; a small valley

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Giroux.

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Question 3

(Suggested time—40 minutes. This question counts as one-third of the total essay section score.)

“ . . . the beauty of the world . . . has two edges, one of laughter,
one of anguish, cutting the heart asunder.”
—Virginia Woolf, *A Room of One's Own*

When applied to literature, Woolf's statement suggests that a literary work achieves its greatest power by blending humor and suffering, laughter and anguish. Select a novel or play in which such a blending occurs. Then write an essay in which you analyze the interaction of humor and suffering in the work and the effect of this interaction on the meaning of the work as a whole. Do not merely summarize the plot.

You may choose a work from the list below or from another novel or play of comparable literary merit.

Adventures of Huckleberry Finn

All the King's Men

The Amazing Adventures of Kavalier & Clay

Anna Karenina

Arcadia

As I Lay Dying

The Brief Wondrous Life of Oscar Wao

Broken for You

Cat on a Hot Tin Roof

Catch-22

The Color Purple

The Country Wife

Empire Falls

Extremely Loud and Incredibly Close

Great Expectations

Gulliver's Travels

The Inheritance of Loss

Invisible Man

Mama Day

Miss Lonelyhearts

On Beauty

One Hundred Years of Solitude

Pale Fire

Pride and Prejudice

Pygmalion

Reservation Blues

Rhinoceros

Rosencrantz and Guildenstern Are Dead

Sent for You Yesterday

Sula

The Taming of the Shrew

To the Lighthouse

Tom Jones

Tracks

Twelfth Night

Waiting for Godot

White Noise

Who's Afraid of Virginia Woolf?

Wise Blood

The World According to Garp

Answer Key for AP English Literature and Composition

Practice Exam, Section I

Question 1: B	Question 29: C
Question 2: C	Question 30: C
Question 3: C	Question 31: B
Question 4: D	Question 32: C
Question 5: A	Question 33: B
Question 6: E	Question 34: C
Question 7: C	Question 35: D
Question 8: D	Question 36: B
Question 9: B	Question 37: C
Question 10: B	Question 38: C
Question 11: C	Question 39: D
Question 12: B	Question 40: D
Question 13: E	Question 41: E
Question 14: A	Question 42: B
Question 15: C	Question 43: E
Question 16: D	Question 44: C
Question 17: E	Question 45: A
Question 18: B	Question 46: B
Question 19: C	Question 47: D
Question 20: C	Question 48: B
Question 21: E	Question 49: A
Question 22: A	Question 50: D
Question 23: D	Question 51: D
Question 24: C	Question 52: D
Question 25: D	Question 53: B
Question 26: E	Question 54: D
Question 27: D	Question 55: C
Question 28: A	

2018 AP English Literature and Composition Question Descriptors and Performance Data

Multiple-Choice Questions

Question	Topic	Key	% Correct
1	Comprehension	B	79
2	Interpretation	C	46
3	Interpretation	C	69
4	Interpretation	D	36
5	Interpretation	A	67
6	Interpretation	E	52
7	Interpretation	C	44
8	Interpretation	D	70
9	Interpretation	B	40
10	Interpretation	B	41
11	Interpretation	C	61
12	Recognition of Literary Technique	B	54
13	Comprehension	E	48
14	Comprehension	A	86
15	Interpretation	C	55
16	Interpretation	D	57
17	Interpretation	E	53
18	Interpretation	B	43
19	Comprehension	C	68
20	Interpretation	C	61
21	Interpretation	E	54
22	Interpretation	A	47
23	Interpretation	D	57
24	Comprehension	C	43
25	Comprehension	D	70
26	Interpretation	E	48
27	Recognition of Literary Technique	D	63
28	Interpretation	A	33
29	Interpretation	C	77
30	Interpretation	C	66
31	Interpretation	B	73
32	Interpretation	C	48
33	Interpretation	B	68
34	Comprehension	C	78
35	Interpretation	D	33
36	Interpretation	B	80
37	Interpretation	C	61
38	Interpretation	C	54
39	Comprehension	D	47

2018 AP English Literature and Composition Question Descriptors and Performance Data

Question	Topic	Key	% Correct
40	Interpretation	D	28
41	Interpretation	E	21
42	Comprehension	B	51
43	Interpretation	E	38
44	Comprehension	C	66
45	Interpretation	A	70
46	Interpretation	B	38
47	Interpretation	D	16
48	Comprehension	B	71
49	Interpretation	A	65
50	Comprehension	D	49
51	Comprehension	D	29
52	Comprehension	D	32
53	Interpretation	B	47
54	Recognition of Literary Technique	D	36
55	Interpretation	C	50

AP[®] ENGLISH LITERATURE AND COMPOSITION

2018 SCORING GUIDELINES

Question 1

(Paul Laurence Dunbar, “The Mystery”)

General Directions: This scoring guide will be useful for most of the essays that you read, but in problematic cases, please consult your table leader. The score that you assign should reflect your judgment of the quality of the essay as a whole—its content, style, and mechanics. **Reward the writers for what they do well.** The score for an exceptionally well-written essay may be raised by one point above the otherwise appropriate score. In no case may a poorly written essay be scored higher than a three (3).

9-8 These essays offer a persuasive analysis of how the speaker explores the nature of his own existence and arrives at conclusions about it. Using apt and specific textual support, they demonstrate consistent and effective control over the elements of composition in language appropriate to the discussion of poetry. Although these well-focused essays may not be error-free, they are perceptive in their analysis and demonstrate writing that is clear and effectively organized. Essays scored a nine (9) have especially convincing analysis and effective control of language.

7-6 These essays offer a reasonable analysis of how the speaker explores the nature of his own existence and arrives at conclusions about it. Using textual support, they are organized and demonstrate control over the elements of composition in language appropriate to the discussion of poetry. These focused essays show insight in their analysis, and they offer clear and controlled analysis and writing. Essays scored a seven (7) present solidly developed analysis and consistent control of organization and language.

5 These essays respond to the assigned task with a plausible discussion of how the speaker explores the nature of his own existence and arrives at conclusions about it, but the analysis may be superficial and thinly developed. They often rely on paraphrase or general textual support that includes some analysis, implicit or explicit. Their analysis and discussion may be vague, formulaic, or minimally supported. These essays demonstrate some control of language, but they may be marred by surface errors. These essays have difficulty presenting a cohesive idea, clear organization, or sustained development of analysis.

4-3 These lower-half essays fail to offer an adequate analysis of the poem. The analysis of how the speaker explores the nature of his own existence and arrives at conclusions about it may be partial, unconvincing, oversimplified, or irrelevant. Evidence from the poem may be slight or misconstrued, or the essays may rely on paraphrase only. The essays often demonstrate a lack of control over the conventions of composition: inadequate development of ideas, accumulation of errors, or a focus that is unclear, inconsistent, or repetitive. Essays scored a three (3) may contain significant misreading and/or demonstrate inept writing.

2-1 These essays compound several writing weaknesses. Although these essays make some attempt to respond to the prompt, they are often unacceptably brief or incoherent in presenting their ideas. The essays may be poorly written on several counts; they may contain pervasive errors that interfere with understanding. The ideas may be presented with little clarity, organization, or supporting evidence. Essays scored a one (1) contain little coherent discussion of the text.

0 These essays give a response that is completely off topic or inadequate; there may be some mark or a drawing or a brief reference to the task.

-- These essays are entirely blank.

AP[®] ENGLISH LITERATURE AND COMPOSITION

2018 SCORING GUIDELINES

Question 2

(C. E. Morgan, *All The Living*)

General Directions: This scoring guide will be useful for most of the essays that you read, but in problematic cases, please consult your table leader. The score that you assign should reflect your judgment of the quality of the essay as a whole—its content, style, and mechanics. **Reward the writers for what they do well.** The score for an exceptionally well-written essay may be raised by one point above the otherwise appropriate score. In no case may a poorly written essay be scored higher than a three (3).

9–8 These essays offer a persuasive analysis of how Morgan employs literary elements to convey Aloma’s complex responses to her changing environment. Using apt and specific textual support, the essays demonstrate consistent and effective control over the elements of composition in language appropriate to the discussion of prose. Although these well-focused essays may not be error-free, their perceptive analysis is apparent in writing that is clear and effectively organized. Essays scored a nine (9) have especially convincing analysis and effective control of language.

7–6 These essays offer a reasonable analysis of how Morgan employs literary elements to convey Aloma’s complex responses to her changing environment. Using textual support, they are organized and demonstrate control over the elements of composition in language appropriate to the discussion of prose. These focused essays show insight in their analysis, and they offer clear and controlled analysis and writing. Essays scored a seven (7) have solidly developed analysis and consistent control of organization and language.

5 These essays respond to the assigned task with a plausible reading of how Morgan employs literary elements to convey Aloma’s complex responses to her changing environment, but the analysis may be superficial and thinly developed. They often rely on paraphrase or general textual support that may include some analysis, implicit or explicit. Their analysis and discussion may be vague, formulaic, or minimally supported. These essays demonstrate some control of language, but they may be marred by surface errors. These essays have difficulty presenting a cohesive idea, clear organization, or sustained development of analysis.

4–3 These lower-half essays fail to offer an adequate analysis of the passage. The analysis of how Morgan employs literary elements to convey Aloma’s complex responses may be partial, unconvincing, oversimplified, or irrelevant; the essays may ignore Morgan’s use of literary elements or the portrayal of Aloma’s complex responses. Evidence from the passage may be slight or misconstrued, or the essays may rely only on paraphrase. The essays often demonstrate a lack of control over the conventions of composition: inadequate development of ideas, accumulation of errors, or a focus that is unclear, inconsistent, or repetitive. Essays scored a three (3) may contain significant misreading and/or demonstrate inept writing.

2–1 These essays compound several writing weaknesses. Although they make some attempt to respond to the prompt, they are often unacceptably brief or incoherent in presenting their ideas. The essays may be poorly written on several counts; they may contain pervasive errors that interfere with understanding. Ideas may be presented with little clarity, organization, or support from the passage. Essays scored a one (1) contain little coherent discussion of the passage.

0 These essays give a response that is completely off topic or inadequate; there may be some mark or a drawing or a brief reference to the task.

-- These essays are entirely blank.

AP[®] ENGLISH LITERATURE AND COMPOSITION

2018 SCORING GUIDELINES

Question 3

(Humor and Suffering)

General Directions: This scoring guide will be useful for most of the essays that you read, but in problematic cases, please consult your table leader. The score that you assign should reflect your judgment of the quality of the essay as a whole—its content, style, and mechanics. **Reward the writers for what they do well.** The score for an exceptionally well-written essay may be raised by one point above the otherwise appropriate score. In no case may a poorly written essay be scored higher than a three (3).

9-8 These essays offer a persuasive analysis of the interaction of humor and suffering in a literary work and the effect of this interaction on the meaning of the work as a whole. Using apt and specific textual support, these essays demonstrate consistent and effective control over the elements of composition and language appropriate to their discussion. Although these well-focused essays may not be error-free, they make a strong case for their interpretation and discuss the literary work with insight and understanding in writing that is clear and effectively organized. Essays scored a nine (9) have especially convincing analysis and effective control of language.

7-6 These essays offer a reasonable analysis of the interaction of humor and suffering in a literary work and the effect of this interaction on the meaning of the work as a whole. Using textual support, these essays are organized and demonstrate control over the elements of composition and language appropriate to their discussion. These focused essays show insight in their analysis, and they offer clear and controlled analysis and writing. Essays scored a seven (7) have solidly developed analysis and consistent command of the elements of effective composition.

5 These essays respond to the assigned task with a plausible reading, but they tend to be superficial or thinly developed in analysis. They often rely upon plot summary that includes some analysis, implicit or explicit. Although the essays attempt to analyze the interaction of humor and suffering and how such interaction contributes to the meaning of the work, they may demonstrate a rather simplistic understanding of the work. While these essays demonstrate adequate control of language, they may be marred by surface errors. They have difficulty presenting a cohesive idea, clear organization, or sustained development of analysis.

4-3 These lower-half essays fail to offer an adequate reading of the interaction of humor and suffering in a literary work and the effect of this interaction on the meaning of the work as a whole. The analysis may be partial, unsupported, oversimplified, or irrelevant, and the essays may reflect an incomplete understanding of the interaction and its effects. They may rely on plot summary that is not in service to a clear idea. These essays may be characterized by an unfocused or repetitive presentation of ideas, an absence of textual support, or an accumulation of errors; they may lack control over the elements of composition. Essays scored a three (3) may contain significant misreading and/or demonstrate inept writing.

2-1 These essays compound several writing weaknesses. Often, they are unacceptably brief or incoherent in presenting their ideas. They may be poorly written on several counts; they may contain pervasive errors that interfere with understanding. The writers' remarks may be presented with little clarity, organization, or supporting evidence. Essays scored a one (1) contain little coherent discussion of the text.

0 These essays give a response that is completely off topic or inadequate; there may be some mark or a drawing or a brief reference to the task.

-- These essays are entirely blank.